



Manual Deletion of Backup Files from D Drive (windows)

Preparation

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Objective

To manually delete obsolete or excess backup files from the **D drive** on a Windows server in a controlled and secure manner in order to free up disk space, prevent warning alerts, and ensure system stability while adhering to organizational data retention and security policies.

Scope

Applies to **Windows Servers** where backups are stored locally on the **D drive**. • Specifically covers manual cleanup of **backup files (e.g., .zip, .ezip, .bak, .vhd, or application-specific backup files)**. • Can be applied to other Windows servers experiencing disk space issues due to backup file accumulation. • Includes verification and alert clearance post-cleanup.

Pre-requisites

- Administrative or appropriate file system access to the Windows server.
- Approval to delete backup files as per **data retention policy**.
- Confirmation of **backup retention requirement** (e.g., keep last 2 days only).
- Remote Desktop (RDP) or console access to the server.
- Disk space alert or monitoring notification (if applicable).
- Change request or incident ticket approved (if applicable).

Responsibilities

Activity	Role
Implementation	Server Admin / Operations Team
Approval	Team Lead / Manager
Review & Audit	Security / IT Compliance Team
Documentation	Operations / Infrastructure Team

Do's and Don'ts

- **✓ Do's**
 - Verify backup retention policy before deleting any files.
 - Take note of file names, sizes, and dates prior to deletion.
 - Delete only **older or non-required backup files**.

- Ensure sufficient free space is available after cleanup.
- Validate that services and backups are functioning post-cleanup.
- Update the ticket with cleanup confirmation and alert status.

X Don'ts

- Do not delete the most recent or active backup files.
- Do not delete files without proper approval.
- Do not delete system or application-critical files.
- Do not perform cleanup during active backup jobs.
- Do not permanently delete files without validation (use Recycle Bin or move temporarily if required).

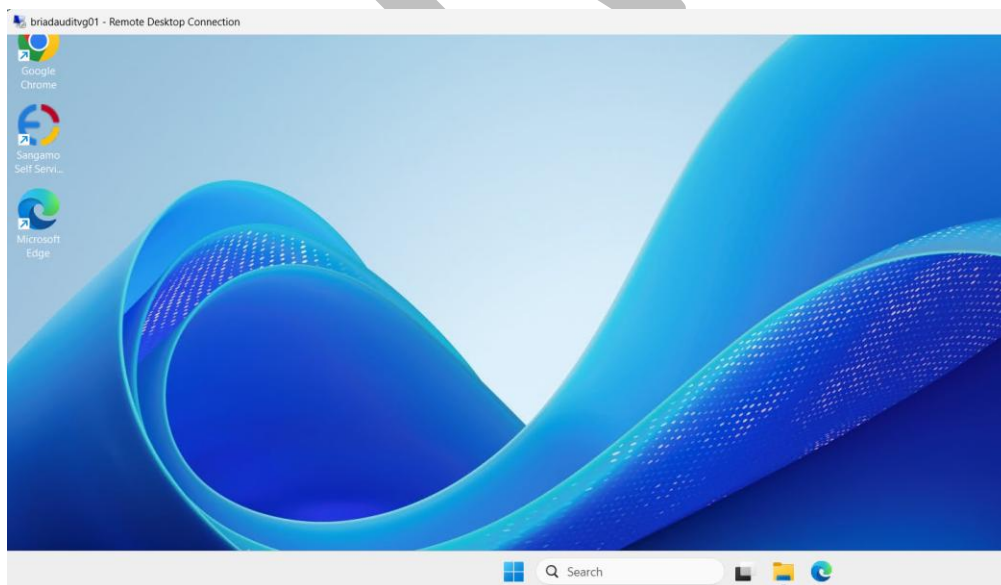
Tools & Commands

- Windows File Explorer
- Remote Desktop (RDP)
- Disk Management / File Properties
- (Optional) Command Prompt or PowerShell<NewPasswor

Procedure / Steps to Follow

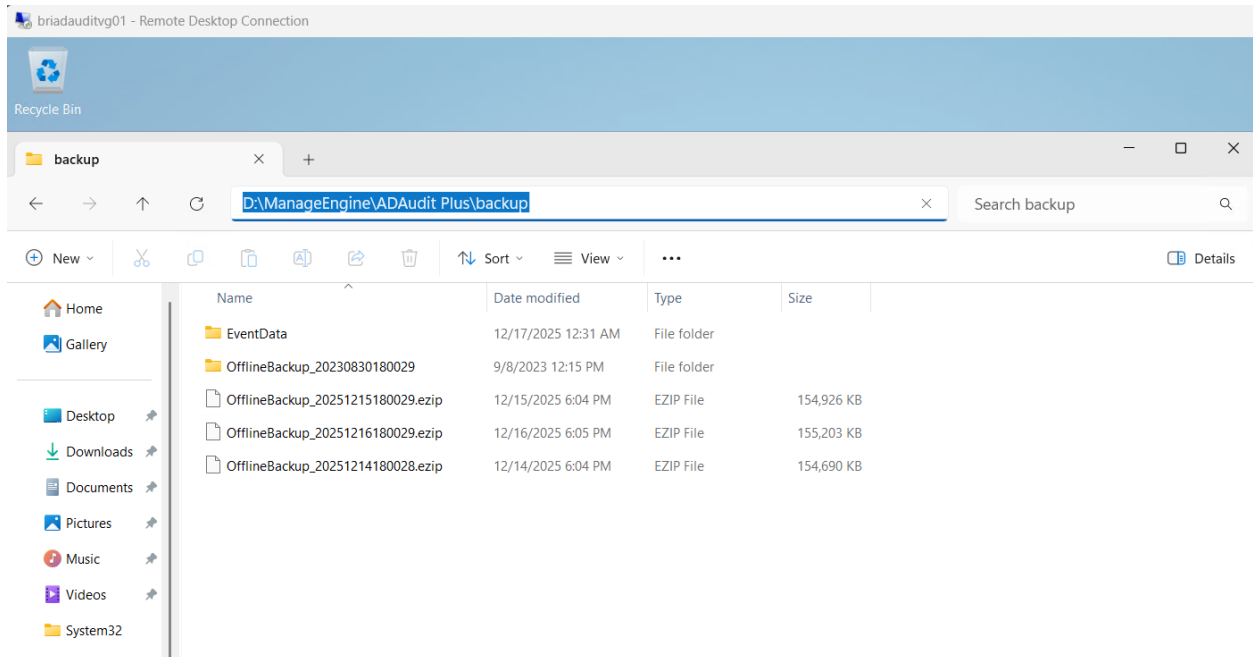
Step 1 – Login to Windows Server

- Connect to the server using **RDP** or console access.
- Login with an account having appropriate permissions.



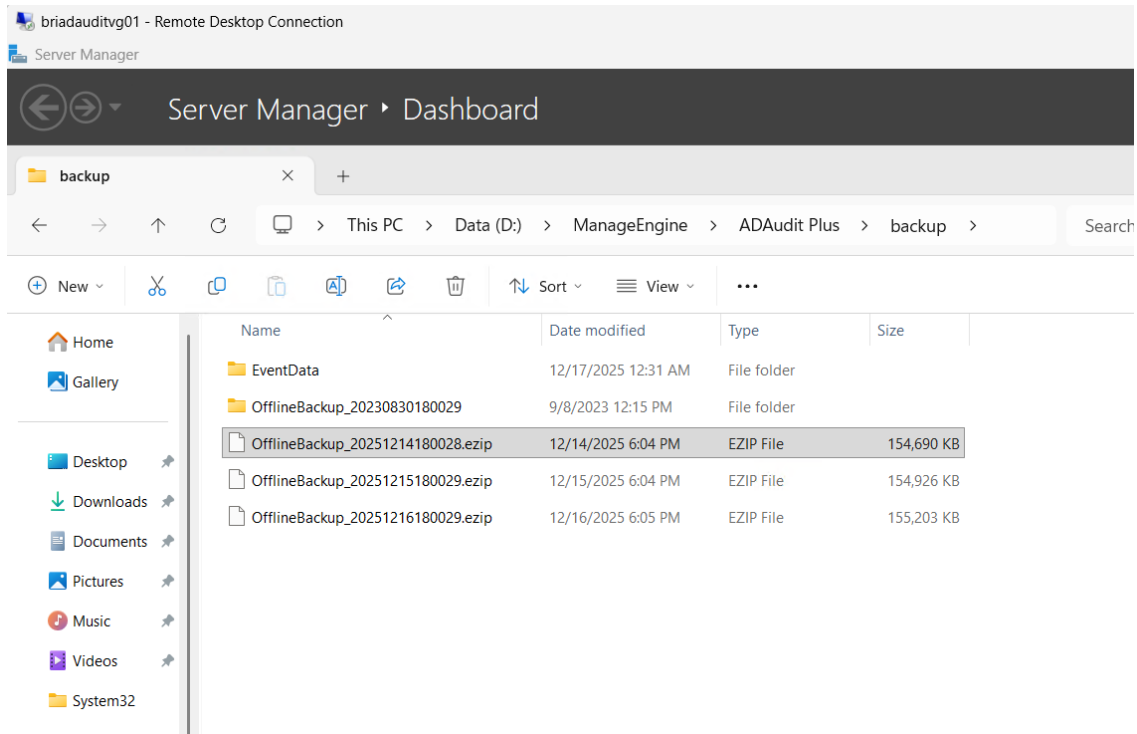
Step 2 – Navigate to Backup Location

- Open **File Explorer**.
- Navigate to ***D:*** drive.
- Locate the backup folder (e.g., D:\ManageEngine\ADAudit Plus\backup).



Step 3 – Identify Files for Deletion

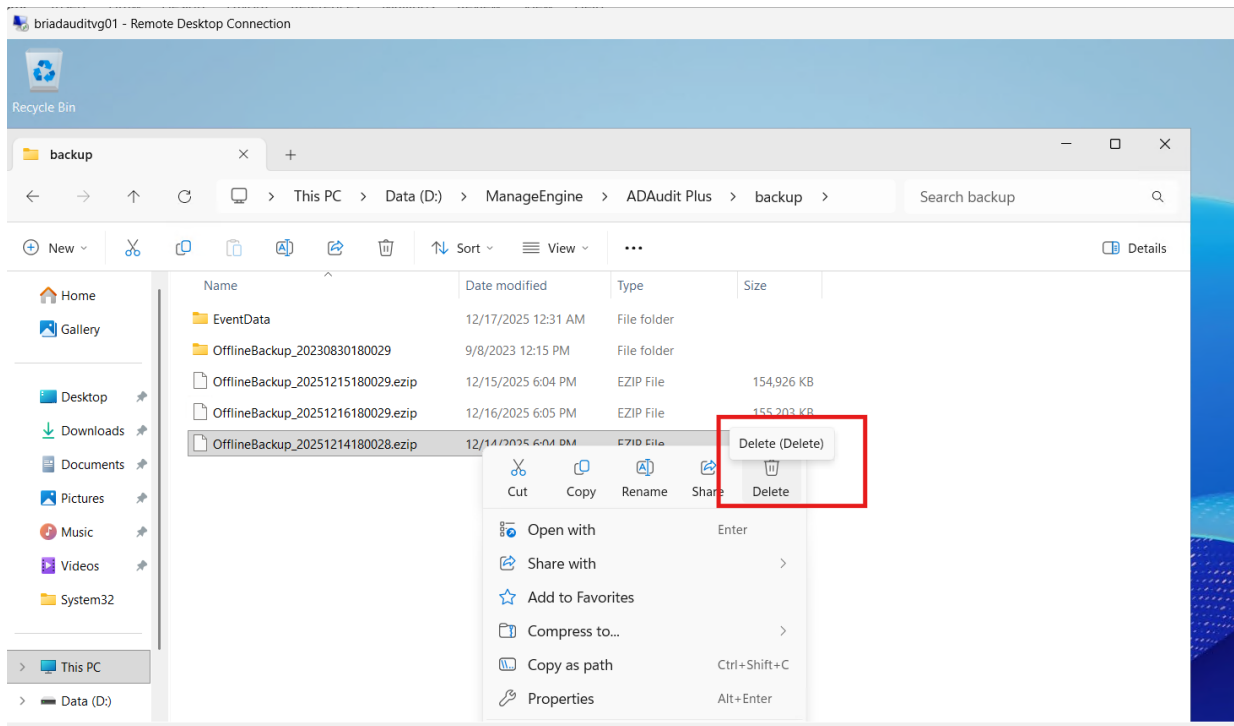
- Sort files by **Date Modified**.
- Identify backup files older than the approved retention period (e.g., files older than last 2 days).
- Verify file type and size to ensure they are backup-related files only.



Step 4 – Delete Backup Files

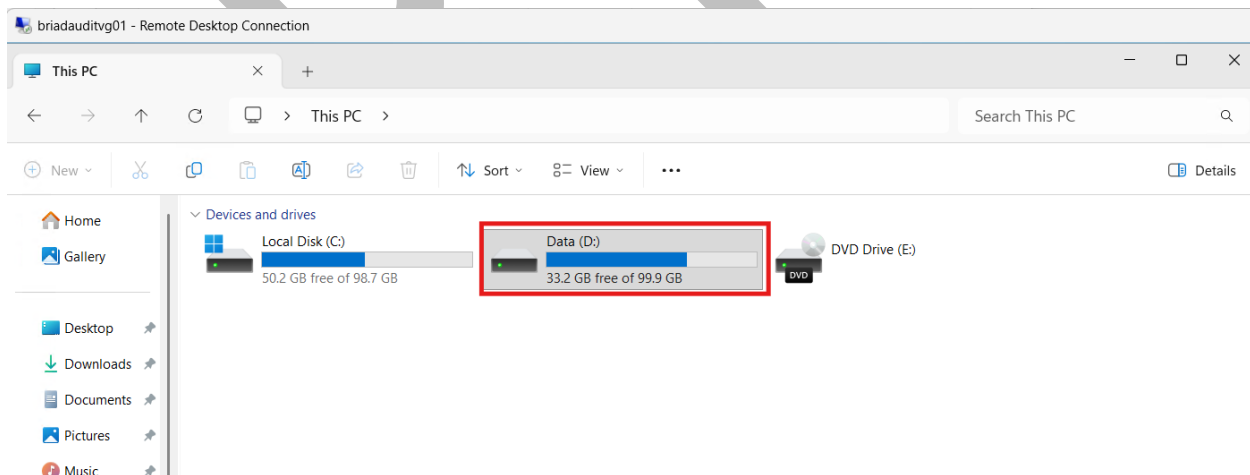
- Select the identified old backup files.
- Right-click and select **Delete**.
- Confirm deletion.
- (Optional) Empty Recycle Bin if immediate disk space is required.

Backup files have now been deleted successfully.



Step 5 – Verify Disk Space

- Right-click on **D drive** → Select **Properties**.
- Confirm available free space has increased.
- Ensure disk utilization is within acceptable threshold.



post-validation

- Confirm disk space warning alert is cleared.
- Verify no application or backup job failures.
- Check system and application logs for errors.

- Ensure monitoring tools reflect normal disk utilization.
- Update the incident/change ticket with successful cleanup details.

References

- Company Backup & Retention Policy
- Windows Server Administration Guide
- IT Operations Standard Operating Procedures

Rollback Plan

- If an incorrect file is deleted or an issue occurs:
 1. Restore the file from Recycle Bin (if not permanently deleted).
 2. Restore from centralized or secondary backup (if available).
 3. Inform the application or backup owner immediately.
 4. Escalate to the Infrastructure or Backup Team if recovery is required.

Escalation

Level	Role	Responsibility
L1	Server Support	Initial investigation & cleanup
L2	Infrastructure Lead	Approval & troubleshooting
L3	Backup / Security Team	Retention & compliance validation
L4	IT Architect / Vendor Support	Advanced recovery or design review